

Chris Melançon - Technologist

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Product leader with 15+ years owning customer discovery, product roadmaps, and commercialization of analytical technologies in environmental diagnostics, molecular testing, and agricultural innovation. Founded and led an in-situ genomics and mass spectrometry business from concept through commercial launch, securing contracts with U.S. EPA, NSF, and research institutions. Most recently led Stratifyx, an AI-powered land stewardship startup, running hypothesis testing and go/no-go evaluation to define product-market fit. Uniquely combines deep agricultural domain expertise with founder-level ownership, hands-on engineering collaboration, and customer-first discovery.

CORE SKILLS

Product Ownership & Discovery • Customer-First Strategy & Direct Engagement • Go-to-Market & Commercialization • Technical Fluency & Engineering Collaboration • Analytical Technology & Diagnostics Domain Knowledge • Agricultural & AgTech Expertise • AI-Enabled Decision Support • Startup Execution & Early-Stage Leadership • Roadmap Development & Prioritization • Cross-Functional Team Building

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Chief Executive Officer

2024 - 2025

Stratifyx, Inc. - Boulder, CO

- Led an early-stage company building AI-powered, data-driven decision tools that turn land and environmental measurements into risk-reducing, profit-increasing actions for farmers and ranchers. Owned strategy, product direction, and partnerships end to end.
- Positioned the company for a successful strategic acquisition by Pantheon Regeneration.

Co-Founder & Chief Executive Officer

2008 - 2018

Spyglass Technologies, Inc. - San Francisco, CA

- Founded and led an environmental diagnostics company commercializing portable laboratory systems for water and ecosystem monitoring, leveraging genomics and mass spectrometry. Owned the innovation pipeline from concept through commercial launch.
- Secured seed financing and completed in-licensing and manufacturing agreements to win contracts with the U.S. EPA, NSF, Woods Hole Oceanographic Institution, and Monterey Bay Aquarium Research Institute.
- Established an in-house assay validation lab to expand the test menu; grew revenue to \$1M annually with limited external capital.

Vice President, Business Development

2008 – 2009

Enigma Diagnostics - Salisbury, UK

- Led U.S. market entry for a UK-based molecular diagnostics company, evaluating and executing strategic partnerships and out-licensing agreements.
- Opened the U.S. office and launched an influenza testing portfolio across U.S. and East Asian markets, including participation in U.S. military field trials.

General Manager

2004 – 2008

Applied Biosystems (Life Technologies / Thermo Fisher Scientific) - Foster City, CA

- Held full P&L responsibility for a \$50M business unit delivering early-warning molecular diagnostics for infectious disease surveillance and biosecurity threats.
- Commercialized a new testing portfolio in 60+ countries within 15 months and led a high-growth pathogen-testing program for the U.S. Postal Service.
- Built and executed a government affairs strategy that advanced biodefense and infectious disease legislation, coordinating directly with regulators and legislators.

EARLY CAREER

- Director, Product Marketing, Oracle, Inc. (via Siebel Systems): led marketing of vertical applications within a \$150M enterprise software product line.
- Director, Product Marketing, OnLink Technologies, Inc.: managed the product portfolio for a B2B software company acquired by Siebel Systems.
- Chief of Staff / Program Manager, Citigroup/Citibank: managed operations and strategic planning for a technology division.
- Infantry Officer – Airborne/Ranger, U.S. Army: led operations and personnel in high-accountability environments.

ADDITIONAL OPERATING EXPERIENCE – REGENERATIVE LAND MANAGEMENT

Principal, *What Feeds You, LLC (Advisory Practice), California & Colorado, 2022 - Present*

Advise land stewards, homesteaders, and small-scale producers on regenerative agriculture, holistic management, and permaculture design, translating ecological principles into resilient operating models.

Executive Director & Farm Manager, *Fairview Gardens Farm, Santa Barbara, CA, 2021 - 2022*

Led the turnaround of a 12-acre certified-organic educational farm delivering 30,000+ lbs of produce annually; redesigned the operating model for long-term financial and ecological sustainability.

Co-Founder & Agrarian, *LOLA Sonoma Farms, Sonoma, CA, 2013 - 2021*

Built and operated a diversified regenerative farm business from 12 acres of dormant pasture, owning financials, production, and distribution; secured USDA grants for soil health and ecosystem resilience.

EDUCATION

Masters of the Environment - University of Colorado, Boulder

B.S., Applied Physics - Colorado State University

MBA - Tulane University

B.S., Mechanical Engineering - United States Military Academy, West Point